

Lesson 2 – The Foundations of Purpose (1.5 hours)

Module: Understanding Purpose in Life (UPL) | Course: Youth Impact Training Programme (YITP)

Content Type	Text Content
Estimated Duration	90 minutes
Mandatory	Yes
Published	Yes

Learning Objectives

- Objective: Explore foundational principles for finding purpose.

Lesson Content

Lesson 2 – The Foundations of Purpose (1.5 hours)

Key Topics

Napoleon Hill's Definiteness of Purpose . Definiteness of Purpose – Your True Starting Point {Intro Video Script
■ Get clear – Know exactly what you want. No vague wishes —paint the picture. ■ Get hungry – Want it so badly it pulls you out of bed in the morning. ■ Get moving – Build your plan and take daily action —no excuses. ■ Stay locked in – Focus your mind so opportunities and resources find you. Why? Because a clear purpose gives you direction, draws the right people to you, and fuels your persistence when life gets tough. When you have it, you don't just live life —you design it } Napoleon Hill, one of the greatest voices in personal development, said it clearly: “Definiteness of purpose is the starting point of all achievement.” If you want to achieve anything worthwhile, this is where it begins. Let us break it down, The Success Afrika -style:

Know exactly what you want Don't just say, “I want success” or “I want more money.” Those are vague wishes. Get crystal clear. Paint a vivid picture in your mind of what you want, what it looks like, feels like, and means for your life.

Develop a burning desire for it A definite purpose is not a casual wish you think about when it's convenient. It's that deep, unshakable desire that keeps you awake at night and gets you out of bed in the morning ready to move.

Create your game plan Once you know your target and you feel that burning desire, lay out your plan. Step by step. And keep it flexible —because life will test you, and you will need to adapt without losing sight of your goal.

Take consistent daily action Your definite purpose should show up in your daily calendar. Every day you do something , big or small , that moves you closer to your goal . And you do not stop until it is done.

Focus your mind When your mind is locked onto your purpose, something powerful happens: your subconscious starts working for you. You notice opportunities, people, and resources that you might have overlooked before. Why does this matter a great deal ?

It gives you direction – Your purpose becomes your North Star. You always know if you're on course or drifting.

It attracts resources – People, ideas, and opportunities seem to “find” you because your focus is magnetic.

It builds persistence – When the journey gets tough, your purpose gives you the grit to keep going until you win. When you develop definiteness of purpose, you will no longer just live, you will move with intention. That is the difference between drifting through life and creating a life worth living. Zig Ziglar's Wheel of Life . The Wheel of Life – Your Balance Check Zig Ziglar, one of the greatest motivators of our time, taught that life is like a wheel. If one part of the wheel is flat, your ride through life will be bumpy —no matter how fast you try to go. I like to think of it as your Life 's Balance Scorecard . There are seven key spokes in this wheel:

Career – Your Work & Calling Are you doing work that excites you, challenges you, and adds value to others? Your career isn't just a paycheck —it's part of your purpose.

Financial – Your Money & Resources Money isn't everything, but it touches everything. Are you earning, saving, investing, and giving in ways that support your goals and values?

Spiritual – Your Faith & Inner Compass This is your core —what guides you when life gets messy. Whether through faith,

Core Lesson

week-african-baobab-tree/ The baobab tree is a legendary plant with folktales to boot. It water storage.

In an arid climate, baobabs symbolize life in a landscape where little else can thrive. Its large whitish flowers open at night and fall within 24 hours, creating a beautiful display at both ends of the cycle.

Here is an excerpt from One Earth:

As a succulent, the tree absorbs and stores water from the rainy season in its massive trunk, producing a nutrient-dense fruit in the dry season, which can grow up to a foot long. The fruit contains tartaric acid and Vitamin C, serving as a vital nutrient and food source for many species.

They are also an essential source of water and shelter for hundreds of animals, including birds, lizards, monkeys, and even elephants – which can eat their bark for moisture when there is no water nearby. Bats pollinate the flowers, feeding on their nectar.

If a mere plant is created for specific value and purpose. How much more is your purpose

of our life is to serve others.

1. You have a major purpose
2. You have minor purposes
3. Your minor purposes must feed into your major purpose, not out of it.
4. You discover your purpose and you discover your true life's meaning.

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Definiteness of Purpose – Your True Starting Point

{Intro Video Script

Get hungry – Want it so badly it pulls you out of bed in the morning.

Stay locked in – Focus your mind so opportunities and resources find you.

Why? Because a clear purpose gives you direction, draws the right people to you, and fuels your persistence when life gets tough.

Napoleon Hill, one of the greatest voices in personal development, said it clearly:

anything worthwhile, this is where it begins.

Let us break it down, The Success Afrika-style:

1) Know exactly what you want

crystal clear. Paint a vivid picture in your mind of what you want, what it looks like, feels like, and means for your life.

2) Develop a burning desire for it

A definite purpose is not a casual wish you think about when it's convenient. It's that deep, unshakable desire that keeps you awake at night and gets you out of bed in the morning ready to move.

3) Create your game plan

Once you know your target and you feel that burning desire, lay out your plan. Step by losing sight of your goal.

4) Take consistent daily action

Your definite purpose should show up in your daily calendar. Every day you do something, big or small, that moves you closer to your goal. And you do not stop until it is done.

5) Focus your mind

When your mind is locked onto your purpose, something powerful happens: your subconscious starts working for you. You notice opportunities, people, and resources that you might have overlooked before.

Why does this matter a great deal?

1) It gives you direction – Your purpose becomes your North Star. You always know if you're on course or drifting.

focus is magnetic.

3) It builds persistence – When the journey gets tough, your purpose gives you the grit to keep going until you win.

When you develop definiteness of purpose, you will no longer just live, you will move with intention. That is the difference between drifting through life and creating a life worth living.

Zig Ziglar's Wheel of Life.

The Wheel of Life – Your Balance Check

Zig Ziglar, one of the greatest motivators of our time, taught that life is like a wheel. If one I like to think of it as your Life's Balance Scorecard. There are seven key spokes in this wheel:

1. Career – Your Work & Calling

Are you doing work that excites you, challenges you, and adds value to others? Your

2. Financial – Your Money & Resources

Money isn't everything, but it touches everything. Are you earning, saving, investing,

and giving in ways that support your goals and values?

3. Spiritual – Your Faith & Inner Compass

4. Physical – Your Health & Energy

Your body is the vehicle that drives you through life. Are you giving it the fuel, rest, and movement it needs to perform at its best?

5. Intellectual – Your Growth & Learning

If you are not growing, you are dying. Are you reading, studying, and stretching your mind so you can keep adding value to the world?

6. Family – Your Relationships at Home

These are the people who know the real you. Are you investing time, love, and presence into your family relationships?

7. Social – Your Friends & Community

No one wins alone. Are you building healthy friendships, networks, and connections that inspire you and keep you accountable?

Know this:

If any one of the spokes is weak, the whole wheel wobbles. If several are weak, time, but it does mean you are aware and working on them consistently.

When your Wheel of Life is round and strong, you do not only survive, but you roll smoothly toward your goals – You thrive!

Habits for a Meaningful Life – Og Mandino

Og Mandino, one of the most inspiring authors ever, taught that a meaningful life is not built overnight, it is shaped by the habits you practice every single day.

Here's how I break down his wisdom for you:

1. Start Each Day with Gratitude

Gratitude sharpens your perspective and keeps you grounded.

2. Greet Each Day with Love in Your Heart

kindness and respect. Love opens doors that force cannot.

3. Persist Until You Succeed

4. Live Each Day as if It is Your Last

5. Master Your Emotions

You cannot always control what happens, but you can control your response. Stay steady when others panic and stay humble when you win.

6. Multiply Your Value Every Day

is the fuel of a meaningful life.

7. Take Action Now: Tomorrow is not promised.

Do not wait for perfect conditions. You will never have all the answers before you start. Move, and clarity will meet you along the way.

The Big Picture:

be the one shaping it.

Activities

Activity: Use Zig Ziglar's Wheel of Life to rate and reflect on different life domains.

Inspirational Quotes

is known as the "tree of life" because it sustains communities through fruit, shelter, and

Get clear – Know exactly what you want. No vague wishes—paint the picture.

Get moving – Build your plan and take daily action—no excuses.

When you have it, you don't just live life—you design it}

"Definiteness of purpose is the starting point of all achievement." If you want to achieve

Don't just say, "I want success" or "I want more money." Those are vague wishes. Get step. And keep it flexible—because life will test you, and you will need to adapt without

2) It attracts resources – People, ideas, and opportunities seem to "find" you because your

part of the wheel is flat, your ride through life will be bumpy—no matter how fast you try to go.

career isn't just a paycheck—it's part of your purpose.

This is your core—what guides you when life gets messy. Whether through faith,

meditation, or reflection, are you staying connected to your deeper “why”?

your journey slows—or stops. Balance does not mean every area is perfect all the

Before you rush into your to-do list, pause. Name the blessings in your life—big or small.

People are your greatest resource. Approach everyone—family, colleagues, even strangers—with

Do not postpone joy, impact, or purpose. Do the thing today—make the call, take the walk, say

“I love you.” Life is too short for “someday.”

Get a little better daily—learn a skill, solve a problem, or serve someone in a new way. Growth

Og Mandino believed—and I agree—that meaningful living is not about chasing things; it is

about becoming more. Practice these habits daily, and life will not just happen to you—you will

Stories & Examples

The Story of the Baobab Tree: According to <https://www.oneearth.org/species-of-the->

and how much life can you sustain and support. This story edifies us that the true purpose

Wisdom & Proverbs